

SMTP port 1025 (to send emails).

Also ensure that *Connection Security* (in *Server Settings* for the account) is *None* (that's for the connection between Thunderbird and DavMail), and configure the other *account settings* according to your requirements.

Next, let's look at LDAP configuration. In your *Account Settings* dialogue box, select *Composition & Addressing* in the left pane and choose *Use a different LDAP server* (Figure 3). Click *Edit Directories*, and you will be shown an LDAP server configuration dialogue box. Click the *Add* button to add your local LDAP server. Here are some sample settings (except the port):

- Name: *Exchange*
- Hostname: *localhost*
- Base DN: *ou=people*
- Port number: *1389* (the port set in DavMail configuration; Thunderbird will use this to fetch address books from Exchange so it can auto-complete email addresses in new messages.)
- Bind DN: *domainname\username*

Click OK twice to return to *Composition & Addressing*, and select the newly created *Exchange* entry under *Use a different LDAP server*.

Calendar configuration

Now you need to synchronise your calendar with Exchange Server to receive event notifications in Thunderbird. For this,

you need the *Lightning* add-on, which you can easily install from <https://addons.mozilla.org/en-US/thunderbird/addon/lightning/>. Next, from Thunderbird's *File* menu choose *New -> Calendar*. Select *On the Network* and click OK. Select *Format as CalDAV* (see Figure 4). Enter *Location* as 'http://localhost:1080/users/my_name@domainname.com/calendar' (sample setting, replace with your details). DavMail's CalDAV port is 1080. Click *Next*. Enter some nickname for your calendar, and click *Next* and *Finish*.



Note: There are various add-ons available other than CalDAV for Thunderbird, like 'Exchange 2007/2010 Calendar and Task Provider' and 'Provider for Microsoft Exchange', which are also useful for calendar configuration in Thunderbird. The first one looked very useful—it allowed me to specify 'Out of Office' settings and automatic responses to meeting requests—but remember that it's not supported for Thunderbird 15 or later.

Voilà! That's it. Now you are ready to use Thunderbird through DavMail to access MS Exchange Server. Go ahead and enjoy the beauty of FOSS! **END!** 

By: Pranav Chauhan

The author works as an IT analyst in a well-known Indian software exporting company, and takes an interest in exploring open source software to spread awareness about using it in day-to-day life.

support@ efyindia.com

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